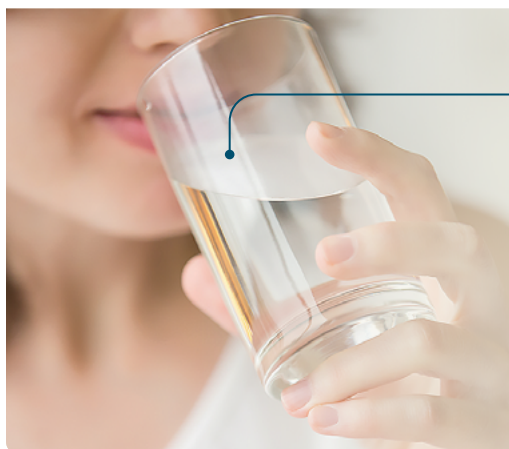




Multi-site Health Study

Community Fact Sheet

Per- and Polyfluoroalkyl Substances (PFAS)
INFORMATION TO PROTECT OUR COMMUNITIES



The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's (CDC) and the Agency for Toxic Substances and Disease Registry's (ATSDR) Multi-site Health Study is the first national study designed to learn how drinking PFAS (per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances)-contaminated water may affect health.

Multi-site Health Study communities are located in California, Colorado, Massachusetts, Michigan, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, and Pennsylvania.

What is the purpose of the Multi-site Health Study?

The purpose of the Multi-site Health Study is to learn how PFAS affect health. The study will measure the levels of PFAS in the blood of participants and see how their health compares to the health of different groups of participants across the country.

Study results will guide decisions to better protect public health in communities exposed to PFAS across the nation.

Who may be eligible for the health study?

Adults who are age **18 and older** and children ages **4 through 17** (with parent or guardian permission) who live in one of the communities where the Multi-site Health Study is taking place may be eligible.

This study focuses only on PFAS in drinking water.
If your job involved making or using PFAS, you are not eligible.

What are PFAS?

PFAS are human-made chemicals used since the 1950s in a variety of products, including some cosmetics; water, grease, and oil-resistant products; and some fire fighting foams.



What is known about PFAS exposure and health effects?

There is much to learn, but some studies show high levels of certain PFAS **may** lead to the following:

- Increased cholesterol levels
- Changes in liver enzymes
- Decreased vaccine response in children
- Increased risk of high blood pressure or pre-eclampsia in pregnant women
- Small decreases in infant birth weights
- Increased risk of kidney or testicular cancer



What tests will the Multi-site Health Study conduct?

Trained health professionals will:

- Collect and test blood and urine samples,
- Take body measurements,
- Ask about medical history, and
- Study behaviors in child participants.

Tests measure immune response, lipid metabolism, kidney function, thyroid disease, liver disease, glycemic parameters, and diabetes.



Are participant's results kept private?

CDC/ATSDR, as well as MSS grantees, are careful to protect all personal information and keep every participant's identity private.



When will the results be available?

It takes a long time to analyze PFAS lab tests, as much as a few years. But, if lab results clearly indicate the possibility of a serious health risk, CDC/ATSDR and the MSS grantee will contact that person with their results right away.

How does PFAS get into drinking water?

When PFAS are made or used they can get into the air, water, or soil. PFAS may travel through soil into groundwater, and then into sources of public and private drinking water.

Who is partnering with CDC/ATSDR for the Multi-site Health Study and where will it take place?

CDC and ATSDR started the Multi-site Health Study in Portsmouth, NH, with the Pease Study to evaluate and improve procedures and methods for the entire study. The following organizations each entered into research cooperative agreements with CDC and ATSDR:

Colorado School of Public Health, University of Colorado Anschutz Medical Campus, **El Paso County, CO**

Michigan State Department of Health and Human Services, **Parchment/Cooper Township and North Kent County, MI**

RTI International and the Pennsylvania Department of Health, **Bucks and Montgomery Counties, PA**

Rutgers Biomedical and Health Sciences – School of Public Health, **Gloucester County, NJ**

Silent Spring Institute, **Hyannis and Ayer, MA**

State University of New York at Albany and the New York State Health Department, **Hoosick Falls and Newburgh, NY**

University of California – Irvine, **communities near the UC Irvine Medical Center**

Do You Live in This Community?

Contact the local site research team to find out if you're eligible to participate in the Multi-site Health Study at this location.

Do you want to know more?

Call CDC/ATSDR at 1-800-CDC-INFO (232-4636)

Email PFAS@cdc.gov

Visit <https://www.atsdr.cdc.gov/pfas/>



National Center
for Environmental Health
Agency for Toxic Substances
and Disease Registry